TRANSCRIPT OF PRIME MINISTER'S SPEECH TO STUDENTS AT UNION HALL, UNIVERSITY OF ADELAIDE ON 30TH MARCH, 1965.

Mr. Chairman, ladies and gentlemen,

It is not my intention this morning to repeat the many matters I have dealt with in the course of my journey to New Zealand and Australia. I think you will find it more interesting if I were to give you the floer after ten or fifteen minutes to put questions to me so that you would be able to let me know what are things you would be interested in.

I would just like to make a few introductory remarks. And the one remark which, I think is worth making is this: You were not here 200 years ago; nor were my forefathers in Singapore. The question, therefore, which arises is will your descendants be here 200 years from now in Singapore?

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You see, the political geography of the world has altered as much in the last 30, 40 years. That is a very brave man indeed who will stand up and say what the colouring of the map of Asia, the Pacific region and of Africa will be at the end of this century.

One think we can all be certain about. If the world has not been blown up, then America will still be there, so will be Soviet Union you may find you are all in one solid block in some kind of economic and political federation. You may find the boundaries in Africa somewhat altered to take into account the demographic composition of the various peoples, and not just latitudes and longtitudes, which is the way the European powers carved up Africa.

By and large, I think you will find the national boundaries of Asia, Southeast Asia, as we are, but I am not quite so sure whether the regimes or the political systems which now exist will endure 50 years or 45 years from today.

So this raises all the imponderables, and the one I am concerned with most is what happens to Malaysia. It was never there in history before, just as Australia was never there is history before, not as one nation state. India had been for many generations, for many centuries in one former one empire after another being one coherent country, more or less; so with the Burmese. The Philippines, Indonesia, well, there were some Hindu empires. Will Indonesia be the same 45 years from now? I wish I knew the answer to that because it will give me a great deal of more certainty as to what we ought to do. But the answers to these very important questions we do not know.

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What we do know is this. That not being able to write history the way we want to, to suit our own separate interests. The next best thing is to try and discern what are the forces at work and to identify what are the forces which are moving or gravitating in the same direction as your own interests militate.

You see, even five years ago, I would say give or six years ago when we were a straight forward anti-colonial phase, I mean, the people versus the British, the rest versus the British, and at that time the Australian image in Singapore, in Malaya, was one in which she was identified with a desire to continue British control ever these territories, or at least, continuance of British bases in Southeast Asia.

1965 finds us in a very different position, not because the position is altered radically but because we've gone through our immediate problems, and are confronted now with our ultimate problems. Our immediate problem then was independence, how to be rid of political domination. That we have achieved. The problem we are confronted now with is what do we do with this independence that we have got. How do we keep it? And, how do we keep it when we are in fact a very small digit in a very power-conscious Asia?

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And, in this situation, the Australians acquire a new image. You see, you are also small; hence also concerned with the survivial, separate independent

survival of small nations, or nations with small populations. So, inevitably your interests drift towards the same conclusions as ours.

The problem in Southeast Asia is partly as a result of the inability of some of these new nations, and some of the old ones who have reemerged, to be able to discern and to identify what are their common interests. And if you look Southeast Asia, you will be astounded at the futile and irrelevant conflicts not in their own interests; conflicts which are exploited by those who know what they want.

I start off with Malaysia. You know, the most serious thing about it is that both the Indonesians and the Chinese, to the south of us, and to the north of us, are determined that this should be destroyed, and for very diverse reasons. People find it difficult to understand, and people cannot understand why the Indonesians want to destroy it. It is very simple. If you look at the island of Borneo you can see how nicely it will fit if it were all coloured in the map in the same hues as the rest of Indonesia. And for that matter, so you can envisage how neat this whole region would be if even Malaya and Singapore and parts of the Philippines were fitted into the jigsaw-puzzle of the Indonesian archipelago.

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But, is it necessary, was it wise for them to have mounted this confrontation; was this the way to absorb Malaysia? By conflict? Would it not have been better for Indonesians to play this softly, quietly over the years, welcomed Malaysia, have more cultural exchanges, more conferences to settle spelling differences of the Malay language in the Romanised script, exchange of literature, songs, poems, ideas.

Well, perhaps that was the way they should have done it if they wanted to be successful; take time, slowly burrow away and take it over; as they probably wanted to do; but for diverse reasons, they are unable to continue the soft line because of internal problems, demanding something more dramatic. But the people find it hard to understand why, what the Chinese Government wants out of helping Indonesians destroy Malaysia. You see, the Indonesian line is: Malaysia is a menace to Southeast Asia because Malaysia will be eventually dominated by the Chinese since the Chinese constitute the largest single component part of Malaysia; 42%, the Malays are 39%, the others are 19% -- Dayaks, Dusuns, Muruts, Kadazans, Indians, Pakistanis, Ceylonese, Eurasians. Well, if the Indonesian line is right, that left to itself Malaysia must become Chinese . Then it doesn't make sense, does it? For them, Chinese, to go and help them destroy Malaysia? So, obviously, one side is wrong. Either the

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Indonesians are shooting a false line, or the Chinese do not believe the Indonesians. And they say, yes, you carry on destroying.

And I say strange as it may appear, I think Indonesia, the nearer it may be to Malaysia; near though it may be physically to the problems of Malaysia, is very far from the truth. In destroying, or attempting to destroy her, she would be containing or destroying what they call the Chinese menace in Southeast Asia. That isn't true. I think the way they will bring this about is to bring about racial conflict in Southeast Asia. If they really succeed, partly due to their propaganda and partly due to our own internal stupidity, in accentuating racial, cultural linguistic difference to a point of no return, then Southeast Asia will be faced with a Sudetanland; problems will emerge.

And I think the Chinese Government is cognisant of all the factors, and in that situation a Communist Party must win not only in Malaysia, or probably in Malaya -- because the Communist Party of Malaya has never become the Communist Party of Malaysia, it is still the Communist Party of Malaya, and the Sarawak Communist Party is still distinct and separate -- if you got an accentuation of the conflict until it is reduced to an armed one when they must emerge triumphant. And even more important, a situation will develop in which the Indonesian Communist Party must emerge.

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So, you see, although on the surface it is manifestly a paradox that two powers with opposing and conflicting objectives should be at one in wanting to destroy Malaysia. One power must be wrong in its calculations. And it is left to history to see whether first they are able to destroy Malaysia, and if they do, then I would have lost interest as to who was right and who was wrong.

And, so far as Australian are concerned, you can only strive in so far as you can to act in your own best interests to be as friendly with the Indonesians as is compatible with your own adding national interest of security.

As a Malaysian, I would like to see all the powers openly committed on your side. But if I were an Australian, I would do a great number of the things your Government is doing. I would want to stop aggression because if aggression begins to pay off each time, then one day it must be Australia's turn, if not in East New Guinea something worse and closer home. But at the same time, that principle having been upheld and having committed Australia to that basic and fundamental tenet of your foreign affairs, I think you will try for as long as you can to be friends, if not with the regime, at least with the people of Indonesia; for regimes can come and go.

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And the problem which you face is one which is only slightly less than the dilemma the Americans face. They would like to see stability in Southeast Asia. They would like to stop this adventure -- all confrontation which must bring about more instablity. But for them to come out openly against confrontation in Malaysia's support and committing the strength of America in defence of Malaysia's support and committing the strength of America in defence of Malaysia against Indonesia means cutting her alliance with Indonesia. That alliance is very important to them if they are to exercise any influence as to what happens when succession has to be considered, from the present regime to the next one.

So with these preliminary remarks, I give the floor to you and I'll answer any questions you want me to answer in so far as I can without embarrassing either the Government of which I am a guest or the Federal Government of which I am a subject, or more important still, my colleagues and I.

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QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS THAT FOLLOWED THE SPEECH

Question: Mr. Lee Kuan Yew has mentioned two forces: racialism and nationalism. Which does he think, will be the most important..?

Prime Minister: I'm sorry if I don't recollect mentioning these two forces -- racialism and nationalism. I would have thought that in most cases they were indistinguishable, because if you are an Indian nationalist -- for Indian is a bad example -- if you are a Ceylonese nationalist, you are also Sinhalese racist; if you are an Australian nationalist you are also an Australian racist up to a point. It's only distinguishable in countries like Malaysia where nationalism must embrace a much wider concept than the various racial component parts of the nation. I wouldn't like to go into dissertation now as to what would be the driving force in Southeast Asia. I think it is impossible to deny the tremendous appeal of one race, one language, one people, one nation, it's simple, its graphic, is vivid -- it is the oldest herd instinct in man -- all kangaroos go together and birds of a particular type go together. But the problems we are confronted with surely is much more complex now than just this primitive primeval appeal to man's basic instincts; it is there, it has got to be faced. I think the problem arises from the ideological chellange which communism poses to all the nationalism in Asia and in Africa. I don't know, I hope

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not, but ultimately in Australia, New Zealand, this is the problem you face.

You see, all right, so the Indians have become independent. So you have satisfied that urge. You are yourself, you are in charge of your country. But was that the basic ambition of the millions who suffered in order to bring that about? Was it not really to get a better life? Or, at least a more just life where you are not constantly irked? At the injustice of the other man having the Rolls-Royce for no apparent reason, or in any way for no reason which you can see and why you shouldn't have, if not a Rolls-Royce, at least a scooter. This is the challenge. And if you are unable over the decades, I mean, it's not a battle which will be won or lost in the next few years; it is going to go on till the end of the century and into the next. If over the years, in fact, the Communist system in spite of its regimentation and in spite of its discipline, in spite of its ruthelessness and disregard for human values, does produce a transformation in the material well-being of the people, and gives them greatness of power,

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heavy industry, a modern society, then I think Asia is in for similar revolutions. What can anybody do in that revolution?

Let us take a very simple illustration: North Vietnam, South Vietnam. In 1954, they carved it up into two broad boundary lines at the 17th Parallel. I am not here to give away points to North Vietnam. It's not my business to help the other side. I don't want Communism for many reasons. The most compelling one being that I'll have no place in it. (loud applause); for the simple reason that they don't have a place for dissenting views, and dissenters. That having been said, I think it is foolish of me to deny the realities, the fact that they have organised the community ruthlessly; if you lie, unpleasantly. But it is a very far cry from South Vietnam where you have go chaos, a base which is completely emasculated and stunted. There, you've got cohesive, effective discipline; goes on another 20 years. It begins to emerge - it begins to manufacture bicycles, scooters. Can the Americans give a scooter to the South for each scooter manufactured in the North? You can't do it. It's an unequal

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fact in the end. So, you see, you can only fight and win this. If won -- I am sure that the will to resist is not melted away by the number of what would happen if you lose -- and second, by giving the people who have got the will to resist an opportunity to develop and flourish on their own. In other words, you've got to help these countries emerge into a modern world. You've got to make it possible for them to build up sinews of their own; giving them, you know, the free bus, free motor car. The free presidential aeroplane is not going to solve anything. But giving them the techniques by which untimately they manufacture this car and manufacture this aircraft. It is the way in which you meet the challenge which, I think, is the challenge of this century: whether the world can find another way for underdeveloped, or non-developed nations to become developed ones without long decades of gestation. The Communists are proving that they can do it; something we've go to live with. I think we can do it, too, given the right conditions.

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If you begin to look at this, not from short-term gains of what do you get out of this, but whether the battle can be held in

the long run, then I think we begin to see these things perspectively. And, it is only on that basic that the fight is worthwhile.

Question: (NOT CLEARLY AUDIBLE) Since Singapore joined the Malaysian Federation, you have confrontation involving economic.... What has been that Singapore gets out of joining Malaysia?

Prime Minister: Well, often get that question put to me by my Communist United Front opposition (very loud applause). They can list other and more painful woes, like bombs being exploded in bank building; innocent workers being killed; innocent workers losing their jobs as a result of confrontation and of closing down of about 20 percent of our enterpot trade, worse, as a result of stupidities and follies of our Federal Government who insist on robbing us of our textile quota when we fought to get it from the British. And so, we can go on. Well, I don't think it is an answer which, whether we were right or wrong in going into Malaysia, is not an answer which will be apparent in one or two or even three years;

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something which has got 5, 10, 15 years before the reasons why we went into Malaysia will be put to the test. If Singapore were the size of one of the bigger Rhio Islands like Batam? Say the size of South or the whole of the State or Johore, then with water resources of its own, then I think, the temptation to go it alone would have been almost irresistible. Our water comes from the mainland. Our economy is dependent on the mainland, the whole political and economic infra-structure was in fact one until the British divided it into two in 1945 after the war in order to suit their own military and strategic purposes.

They had the political boundaries of the Old Malaya, you know, the old Sultanates which they called Protectorates and they had three settlements of Singapore, Malacca and Penang. But whoever was the Governor of the Straits Settlements was also High Commissioner of Malaya and the Malay States, and the Civil Service was one, the Telecommunications was one, the Currency was one, and the things functioned as one unit. And then, when they returned in 1945, for reasons of military strategy they decided to cut it off from the rest of the mainland. In other words, they

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acknowledged the fact that it was impossible to hold the Peninsula in perpetuity while it was just possible that they might hold this island as a base for evermore.

And, it was not till 1961 when we refused to take any step towards preserving the security of the British base without merger and re-establishment of our link with Malays that the British came around to the other point of view.

I'll put it very simply in this way. That if we wanted to pay short-term, it would have suited the British excellently because that was exactly what they wanted us to do: cut off from the mainland, faced with a market which is there but which can be shut off at any moment because politically it is separated, we would have been open to economic blackmail.

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I mean, it's a separate State: they were cutting up the universities into two; they were cutting up the banks into two; they were cutting up the Telecommunications Department into two. At the time when we get them around to think of reuniting the territories, they were thinking of cutting the

currency up in to two so that every time we went up across the causeway we will have to see the money-changer.

Well, in that situation you cannot resolve the unemployment problem; you've got a large urban population highly sophisticated, extremely alert politically, and prepared to man the barricades at the drop of a hand. That being so, the only way to govern it was repression. They are unable to have their jobs, their houses, their schools. You then have got to stifle the manifestations of this disaffection. Well, we refused because we said this is not the way the problem can be resolved.

The British would have been quite happy to take half, if not more, of the responsibility, because they were in charge of the Internal Security Council. But we said, well, you do it.

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We don't want to do it. But they did their own calculations and discovered that it would be untenable, not possible.

So, the long laborious process of persuading the Malayan Government that if we refused to secure British bases, then

Malaya could allow the Communists to expand their influence, then Malaya must be undermined.

And the price for our being prepared to put the house in order is integration of economically viability. It's as simple as that. I would be the first to admit that we haven't as yet, whilst we have brought this argument home to them, we have not emotionally brought them forward -- I mean, you see, we have this problem recently about the textile quota. The British decided to slap a ban on; give us a quota less than Spain. We pointed out that we were buying more from Britain than the Spaniards were. Then, in any case, they were fascists and surely, we could not be fascists and the British thought it ws worthwhile defending us from Indonesia.

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So, as a result of a decision taken by us to put certain British commodities on a restrictive quota, we get a better offer made. Then, when the offer was not sufficiently realistic to meet the problems of unemployment which was being caused by that restriction of imports, our National Trade Union

Congress announced that it will not handle -- at least our harbour workers will not handle -- certain classified goods that came from Britain. Well, then much more realistic approach was taken, and a better quota was offered.

But unfortunately the Federal Government thought this was a magnificent opportunity for them to start their own textile industry, and they decided to take over the quota. So, you see, it's a long fight. Ultimately, they face the same problem. If you do not let us expand economically, then you must be prepared to meet this with guns. And the more you use the gun the less effective it will be.

I am not prepared to ressolve this with a gun unless I am quite sure that the economic basis is secure. When the economic basis is secure then anybody who tries to make it unsecure I am quite prepared to deal with in a more satisfactory manner without using the gun.

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Question: (INDISTINCT)

Prime Minister: May I paraphrase that question. As I understand it, the assertion you are making which you are asking me to agree or disagree with is that Malaya did not want to take in Singapore as part of Malaysia, wanted to keep it out on a limb, and whatever influence it would bring to bear on Malaya was to be counter balanced or to be counteracted by bringing in the three Borneo states.

Well, the answer to that is yes, I mean, that was what motivated them. But whether they have achieved what they thought they were going to achieve by this is another matter altogether, you see.

Let me explain this. You see, if in fact, the indigenous peoples of Borneo who constitute about, I think 850,000 people, or 7% of the population of Malaysia -- Dayaks, Dusuns, Kadazans, Kinians, Ponians. If, in fact, they were Malaya, or they could be made into Malays, then perhaps the communal arithmetic might have worked out the way they wanted it.

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But whilst they were not Chinese -- I think they were also not Malays they have no intention of being converted into Malays as far as I understand it -- and, so you see, whatever the objective was the result is quite different. The result is Malaysia in which it is no longer possible to play the political arithmetic of Malaya.

Let me explain, this very simply, I mean, to the Australians who would not be familiar with this. In Malaya, 50% of the population are Malays, and they have 65% of the votes. The other 35% are the non-Malays many of whom do not -- the votes, the other 35% are non-Malays votes. But, a large number of them are non-Malays who do not qualify for citizenship and the vote because the were first generation immigrants. That being so, whoever wins the majority of the 65% automatically wins power over Malaya. And so you have the technique of the communally -- segregated parties. So, you see, all Malays unite. But if you can get -- no need to get all of them to unite. You know that they will never all unite. But if you can get say 40 out of the 65% then you are in, you see, because not only have you got the majority but you've

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also got a rural weighting -- all these votes are in the rural areas where one vote in equivaqlent to three votes or 2 1/2 votes in the towns where the non-Malays live; so you win that way.

Wherupon you say, of course, we are not, I mean this is the ideological justification for communally-based parties, they say, well, all Malays have united; now Chinese can unite, the Indians can unite; then we will work with the leaders of the Chinese and the Indians. And then we're all united, you see.

Well, the fallacy of the proposition is that in fact Chinese are now allowed to unite -- supposing I went on to a roof-top and say Chinese, unite! I'll be arrested and charged for high treason, and I will be very foolish to do it also.

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So, what happens is this. Well, all right, you will represent the Chinese, and doesn't matter, if the Chinese won't vote for you, you will go to a Malay area and you'll be voted in, and so, we will say that you have represented the Chinese; that's all right, nobody will know, And, as for the poor Ceylonese

and the Eurasians and the others, I mean, they are too small to matter so they just got to put up with it.

Well, after Malaysia, they were even more determined that this shall be the pattern of policies for Singapore, for Sabah, for Sarawak. So, they came down to Singapore and said, Malays, unite! And, in order that they shall unite you must have an enemy. So the enemy was me; the people they voted for. I mean, the Malaya in Singapore in three predominantly Malay constituencies voted for my party which is a non-racial party, multi-racial party, preaching democratic socialism as a means to eliminate the large imbalance in economic and social developments between our communities. Having worked up all this feelings, Indonesian and Malay extremist elements lit the spark. Well, what did you expect?

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But, they try to repeat this pattern also in Sabah. They have some difficulty with the Chief Minister who was a Kadazan and he was going to be outsted. Finally, there was an interim settlement in which it was agreed that henceforth he will only recruit Kadazans into his party and another Minister who was

a Chinese who will only recruit Chinese into his party, and all Malays will join the party belonging to the Head of State of Sabah.

Well, the process has new been set into motion. The problem they face now is: Can communal politics work successfully in Malaysia? I say no. Because the more you say Malays unite the more you are going to alarm all the non-Malays because you must be uniting for some purposes isn't it? I mean, what are you uniting for? If it is not detrimental to the interests of the non-Malays, surely the thing to do is to say Malaysians unite. For, when you say Malays unite, the non-Malays say, "Well, what is this?" And these Malays constitute 39% of the population. So you get 61% solidly certain to unite against whatever is being united for against them.

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So, you see, in the long run, as I was going to point out to the gentleman who put all the list of woes that Singapore has gone through, I give this one ray of hope to my followers. There is a built-in incentive in the demographic composition of Malaysia for non-communal political whoever plays a

communal line which appeals only to one community automatically places himself in a minority group. By way of example, if I were ideologically that way inclined and I believe in Chinese greatness and supremacy, and I said Chinese unite, then not only will that be stupid and irratic it will also be unsuccessful because you will only get 42% whereupon 58% will say, what are they uniting for; we will fix it.

So you see, the problem that arose was when they said Malays unite, I then counted out them, I spelt out the arithmetic for them which is different in Malaysia - as it was for Malays - and I drew the conclusions which, I hope, would be manifest to them before they embarked on this policy of people uniting on the basis of race, language and religion.

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You've got now the absurd situation where, because we preach non-communalism, we are told that we are inciting communal feelings. And, this is being seriously propounded by people in very high authority in Malaysia that our multi-racial, non-communal politics is exciting communal sentiments. How, I do not know; but so they say. But I can

quite imagine that this is exciting a great number of people who are accustomed to exploit communal sentiments for their political ends because they can now see that if this goes on, their politicking goes on in this line, it must fail as it should and justly must do.

Question: Mr. Lee, do you see yourself (INAUDIBLE)

Mr Lee: Yes, I think it's a very fair question, and I hope I'll give you an equally - I'll give the question a fair reply.

It's a very simple proposition, I think, it's one which is basic to this problem. If, in fact, what we wanted to advance was Chinese interests, then we would never have gone into merger and Malaysia. The way to have advanced Chinese interests was to fight for an independent Singapore, knowing that is was impossible, and that was not viable, but doing that as a ply in order to extract the maximum of advantage. Eventually, you will go into a situation where one will conquer the other. And from Singapore as base, you will then undermine Malaya which is what the Communists proposed that we should do

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together with them that we should turn Singapore into a Cuba, and from Singapore undermine Malaya.

I do not believe that this is the long-term interest either of the Chinese or the Chinese or the Malays or the Indians or the others in Malaysia. This is a problem we have to face:

One hundred-odd years ago, the British went there and found a fairly wealthy country capable of exploitation but without the labour to exploit it because the Malays were not keen, or who are not temperamentally suited for regimented plantation or mine work, and so they imported Chinese and Indian labour. One hundred years of this have produced the economy of Malaysia in which the Malays are still, by and large, a rural community and the Chinese and the other immigrant peoples are running the banks, the insurance, the professions and so on.

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We face now an acute test: Whether we are able to replace an authority which is representative of the community as we find ourselves after 140 years of British rule, which can command

a loyalty and support of the various peoples of Malaysia. If we cannot, then what has happened in British Guiana, what has happened in Cyprus must find some manifestation in Malaysia. Because it is impossible to do a time-machine operation on the basis of American strip cartoon and say, well, we go back to D-Day minus one, the day before Stamford Raffles landed in Singapore and we turn the clock and history moved back there, and all the Chinese have disappeared, all the Indians have disappeared, all the Ceylonese have disappeared; it's not possible. Just as 200 years ago, you were not here. So I said, 200 years ago, my parents were not there. But just as you build and your forefathers built Adelaide, so my forefathers built a modern city of Singapore and the rest of Malaysia. And with this one difference, that here you have no problem of the indigenous and the migrants. But is Malaysia you have and I think, we've got to take a broader view that the migrant communities owe it to the indigenous communities to help them raise their economic and their cultural levels to that of the migrant communities because a community where one

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sector is constantly in a depressed state is not a healthy one and must contain the seeds of his own destruction.

The other question is whether we wanted to advance the course in Singapore as against the course of Malaysia. Well, my answer to that is very simple. In 1959, when we took office, out of nine ministers, I was the only one born and educated in Singapore. Seven others were born and educated in Malaya, one was born in Singapore and educated in Malaya. They all had their families there, they drifted to Singapore because it was the biggest city. It is impossible to get people whose roots are Malayan to think in terms of parochial Singapore interests.

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And if Singapore was interested only in its own survival, and not in the rest of Malaysia, our arrangements for federation would have been different because then when we would have taken the Tunku at his words: he wanted the minimum to do with Singapore because he wanted the corollary that Singapore should have the minimum to do with Malaya. And, we insisted that certain basic things were necessarily.

Pan-Malayan and had to be one. And, he for various reasons, decided that the Borneo territories should come in together and become Pan-Malaysian. And so it is, and you know, as the saying goes, you can't get the eggs out of an omelette, it's gone into the omelette and we have got to eat it. And I hope, with a great deal of forebearance and patience with each other and accommodation, because the price for failure is so catastrophic, I am quite sure, we'll be prepared to make the adjustments to ensure success.

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